



The Jaguar XF Pure

Sometimes, luxury is all about the drive.

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The Jaguar XF goes head-on with two massively popular luxury sedans in India – the BMW 5 series and the Mercedes-Benz E-Class. With such stiff competition, and the likes of Lexus ES300h and Volvo S60 knocking on the door, the Jaguar XF has its work cut out to establish itself as a worthy mid-segment luxury sedan.

If you go by the looks, the Jaguar XF certainly does its bit to set the right impressions about itself. The swooping roofline sits well with the long wheelbase, and the aggressive nose adds to the aesthetics that make it look like a baby XJ. The XF is also more aggressively designed in comparison to the entry-level Jaguar XE, and simply looks more plush.



Coming to the technology inside, the Jaguar XF Pure is the base variant, and naturally does not get a lot of the advanced elements that the top-of-the-line XF Portfolio (or XF R) does. The XF Pure does not even get a sunroof, which seems a bit off-putting for a car of this price. You get the standard array of SD card slot, USB slots, 12V power sockets, and Bluetooth connectivity. All of these features are also reflected on the MFD integrated in the instrument cluster, and include music playback from multiple sources, tuner (FM/AM), a 3D satellite-based navigation unit, phone controls, drive data, and valet mode. The music interface scrolls your local music, making playback easy to access. You also get album art and a well-laid-out interface to toggle tracks, and the responsive touchscreen interface makes it easy to operate. You can also control music from the steering wheel, with navigation and volume buttons.

The navigation system is swift and easy to operate, although the graphic-heavy interface takes some time to get used to. However, once you get the



hang of it, the trick is to add the right postcode and choose building names from the recommended list that follows. Routes are accurate, although you do not get traffic data on the InControl map. The phone settings are easy to access, and offer a familiar interface in terms of similarity with phones. You also get contacts and call lists, and the only element amiss are text messages (which is probably a good thing).

The Driving Data mode is a comprehensive store that shows drivetrain data, brake statistics, tyre pressure feedback and car diagnostics. One key takeaway from here is that the system reads into almost every element of the car, but as we encountered a failed condenser, there were no system alerts or diagnostic help that showed up, which left us confused. Everything else, though, works as intended.

The Jaguar XF's basic technical package focuses on giving you all the essentials, but you're expected to pay more to get seemingly standard luxury elements like a sunroof, memory seats, power-adjustable steering wheel, or



HUD (increasingly common in the luxury segment today). The most impressive bit, however, is the raw infusion of power from the 177bhp turbocharged diesel engine, which delivers a strong midrange and is incredibly responsive.

The suspension is balanced towards giving a better ride quality, and unless you're on the XF-R, you would rather not push the XF too hard on slightly bumpy roads or around corners. That said, the pillowy ride quality is great to savour from the rear seat, which has excellent thigh support and a healthy recline. Despite the lack of too much technology here, the Jaguar XF certainly does not fail to put a smile on your face as you take to the steering wheel. **4**